

CHAPTER

7

SUPERHERO WORKOUTS FOR FAT LOSS

Becoming a Fat-Burning Machine

One question you may have is: “What should my workouts be like?” While I’ve addressed that earlier to a certain extent, I’d like to give you more information on that ahead of publishing my next book, *Superhero Training*. In addition to what I’m providing below, I’d also like to refer you to my previous books, which will help you in the meantime.

What follows is an introductory three-day-a-week sample workout program to give you an idea of what I’m talking about. You can find much more detailed workouts in my training books. The movements in my books are very unique and are all photographed and explained in tremendous detail.



Monday

Warm up for five minutes on a treadmill, elliptical, bike or whatever cardio you'd like to do. Make sure you do not warm up by stretching when your muscles are cold. If you stretch them at this time, you could cause a major injury. Muscle tissue needs to be warmed up before it can be fully elongated safely.

On Monday, you'll target your legs with classic moves, and you'll hit four of your upper bodyparts (chest, back, shoulders, triceps) for one exercise each. Then you'll finish with abs and core training.

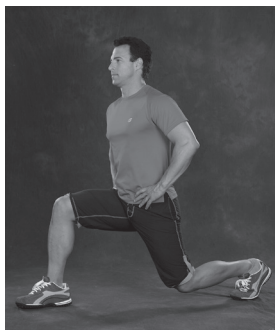
	REPETITIONS	WEIGHTS	SETS
Leg extensions	10-15	(whatever you can do comfortably for 80% and work the last 20%)	2-3
Leg curls	10-15	"	2-3
Squats	10-15	"	2-3
Calf raises	10-20	"	2-3
Dumbbell flat-bench flyes	10-15	"	2-3
Seated rows	10-15	"	2-3
Dumbbell lateral raises	10-15	"	2-3
Triceps pressdowns	10-15	"	2-3
Abdominals crunches	20	0	2-3
Bicycles	20	0	2-3
Planks	5	0	30 seconds per set



Wednesday

After a five-minute warm-up, you'll train your lower body using a variety of different moves than what you did on Monday—you can vary your leg curls by using an alternative version, such as one leg at a time. Then you'll work muscles in your upper body, targeting back, shoulders, chest and biceps. Again, abs and core should come at the end of your training session.

	REPETITIONS	WEIGHTS	SETS
Abduction machine	10-15	(whatever you can do comfortably for 80% and work the last 20%)	2-3
Adduction machine	10-15	"	2-3
Front lunges	10-15	"	2-3
Leg curls	10-15	"	2-3
Lat pulldowns	10-15	"	2-3
Dumbbell bent over rear deltoid flyes	10-15	"	2-3
Dumbbell incline flyes	10-15	"	2-3
Standing dumbbell curls	10-15	"	2-3
Abdominals			
Bicycles	10-20	0	2-3
Hip lifts (back flat, legs up above head, lift up 3-6 inches)	10-20	0	2-3
Side plank	5 per side	0	30 seconds each side per set



Friday

Again, you'll perform a five-minute cardio warm-up. Then you'll target your upper body before your lower on this third training session of the week, hitting all five upper-body muscle groups (back, chest, shoulders, triceps and biceps). Then you'll train your legs and give them two days of rest before your next weight workout on Monday. I incorporate abs exercises into all of my weight-training workouts on this three-day-a-week program.

	REPETITIONS	WEIGHTS	SETS
Push-ups	10-15	(what ever you can do comfortably for 80% and work the last 20%)	2-3
Dumbbell One-arm rows	10-15 per side	"	2-3
Dumbbell kickbacks	10-15	"	2-3
Dumbbell shoulder presses	10-15	"	2-3
Dumbbell hammer curls	10-15	"	2-3
Leg extensions	10-15	"	2-3
Leg curls	10-15	"	2-3
Leg presses	10-15	"	2-3
Abdominals:			
Standing side raises	10-15	"	2-3
Hip lifts	10-20	0	2-3
Crunches	10-20	0	2-3



CARDIO AND WEIGHT TRAINING SCHEDULE

In addition to weight training three times a week, you should also perform a minimum of three cardio sessions each week. Preferably, you should do these on days when you aren't lifting weights. By offsetting cardio and lifting days you will be exercising six days a week. If you want to do more than three days a week of cardio, then you can overlap workout and cardio days. Take a look at my recommendations in Chapter 3.2 to remind yourself when to eat before and after cardio to maximize fat loss.

The purpose is that you'll be working out six days a week to keep revving your metabolism and burning bodyfat. Of course, the level of intensity for these training sessions depends on your current level of fitness. Don't go all-out with every set, rep and cardio session. Follow my guidelines for intensity regardless of your level of fitness. That's crucial because you're also adapting to a different pattern of eating, which is even more critical.

WEEKLY SPLITS

Here are a few different ways you can put together your training program. I realize that you have a busy life, and one of these options may work better for you than others. My goal is to get you to do six workouts a week, regardless of when you perform them. First, is my ideal training split, and then I provide a couple examples of how you can change this up to fit your needs. Feel free to come up with your own program if these don't fit your lifestyle.

Superhero Workout—My Ideal Program Split

Monday:	Weights
Tuesday:	Cardio
Wednesday:	Weights
Thursday:	Cardio
Friday:	Weights
Saturday:	Cardio
Sunday:	Rest

Superhero Workout—An Alternative

Monday:	Weights followed by cardio
Tuesday:	Rest
Wednesday:	Weights
Thursday:	Cardio
Friday:	Weights followed by cardio
Saturday:	Rest
Sunday:	Rest

Superhero Workout—Another Alternative

Monday:	Cardio in the morning; weights later in the day
Tuesday:	Rest
Wednesday:	Cardio (whatever time of day)
Thursday:	Weights (my Wednesday workout)
Friday:	Cardio (whatever time of day)
Saturday:	Weights (my Friday workout)
Sunday:	Rest

So here are my most crucial guiding principles for putting together a workout program that works for you:

- 1) Perform three weight-training sessions a week
- 2) Perform at least three cardio sessions a week
- 3) Try to create a rest day between each of your three weight workouts each week
- 4) But perform the weight workouts back-to-back rather than skipping one
- 5) Back off on any form of exercise for a day or two if you feel overly sore or over-trained

